

baggage that would be needed. They also carried forage for the animals pulling the wagons, which might amount to thousands of sacks of grain. Black teamsters often oversaw the transportation of supplies for the Union army, while the Confederacy brought enslaved laborers to perform such tasks.

Pulled by a six-mule team, the canvas-covered army wagon rolled along at less than 3 miles (4.8km) an hour. Slow though it was, the wagon was the vital link between the individual soldier's haversack and cartridge box, and the huge depots to the rear that stockpiled essential supplies—coffee, sugar, hardtack, salt pork, dried peas, tents, blankets, overcoats, lumber, axes, shovels, saddles, bridles, harnesses, bullets, bandages, and coffins.

**16,000** The number of officers and men in the U.S. Army in 1860, before the war. A year later it had swollen to 186,000, and by the end of the war the Union army totaled more than a million men.



### Food foraging

A contemporary illustration shows Union troops foraging near Wacsaw Sound, Georgia, during General Sherman's 1864 March to the Sea. Sherman's 62,000 soldiers appropriated almost all of the local agricultural resources.